PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

CONFIDENTIAL · V1.0

BUYAFROBEATS PRD

A one-of-one Afrobeats auction house. Upload, bid, win, and the beat vanishes — delivered exclusively to the winner's inbox.

DOC OWNER	STATUS	LAST UPDATED	TARGET LAUNCH
Founder / Producer	Draft for review	Apr 25, 2026	Q3 2026 · MVP

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01 SUMMARY

What we're building

BUYAFROBEATS is a single-producer auction house for exclusive Afrobeats instrumentals. Only the producer (the site owner) lists beats. Every beat is a true one-of-one: when its auction ends, the highest bidder receives the file by email and the listing is permanently removed from the public site.

The product's defining mechanic is a 30-minute countdown that begins when the first bid lands, paired with an anti-snipe extension and a public live leaderboard. This compresses time, creates social proof, and converts passive listeners into active bidders.

> *“ Spotify-style streaming made beats infinitely available and infinitely cheap. BUYAFROBEATS makes them scarce again — and turns each sale into a public event.*

02 PROBLEM & OPPORTUNITY

The producer economy is a race to the bottom

Independent Afrobeats producers today face three structural problems:

1. **Race to the bottom on price.** BeatStars-style marketplaces commoditize beats; the same instrumental gets sold to dozens of artists for $30 a pop with weak licensing.
2. **No urgency, no event.** A beat sits in a catalog forever. There's no moment that pulls fans, A&Rs, or rival producers in to compete.
3. **Exclusive sales are friction-heavy.** A serious "exclusive" deal usually means DMs, invoices, and Dropbox links — slow, untrackable, and easy to get scammed on.

BUYAFROBEATS replaces all of that with a single producer-controlled storefront where every beat is a timed, one-shot event with public stakes.

03 GOALS & NON-GOALS

What success looks like

Goals (in scope for v1)

- Allow **only the site owner** to list beats for auction.
- Allow **any visitor** to preview, place bids, and (if winning) receive a private download by email.
- Make every beat a true one-of-one: removed from the site at auction close.
- Create urgency and social pressure via a 30-min countdown + live leaderboard.
- Provide the producer a private dashboard for catalog, live auctions, and sales history.

Non-goals (explicitly out for v1)

- Multi-producer / open marketplace.
- Subscription, leasing, or non-exclusive licensing tiers.
- Native mobile apps. (Mobile web only.)
- Built-in DAW or stem editor. We deliver finished files only.
- Public bidder profiles, follows, or social graph.

04 TARGET USERS

Who we serve

PERSONA	GOAL	TOP JOB
The Producer site owner · 1 user	Sell exclusive beats at premium prices, with proof of buyer + signed license.	List a beat in <2 minutes; track auctions; deliver winning files automatically.
The Recording Artist indie + signed	Lock down a beat nobody else will ever own.	Discover, preview, and win an auction without losing it to a sniper.
The A&R / Manager	Source unique production for their roster.	Bid on behalf of artists; verify exclusivity in writing.
The Fan / Lurker	Watch the action; flex by winning.	Follow live activity; share auctions; convert from spectator to bidder.

05 USER STORIES

The work we have to make easy

AS THE PRODUCER

I want to upload a finished beat with cover art, BPM, key, genre, and a starting bid so I can put it live in under two minutes.

AS AN ARTIST

I want to preview a beat and place a bid in two clicks so I don't lose the auction to someone faster than me.

AS A LURKER

I want to see what beats are heating up across the site so I get pulled into auctions I would otherwise have missed.

AS AN ARTIST

I want to be notified instantly if I'm outbid so I can decide whether to push higher before the timer ends.

AS THE WINNER

I want to receive my files and license by email automatically so the deal closes the second the timer hits zero.

AS THE PRODUCER

I want a private studio dashboard with revenue, top bidders, and live timers so I can see what's working without clicking around.

06 CORE FLOWS

The auction lifecycle

01 **Producer lists a beat**

Authenticated owner uploads audio file, sets title, genre, BPM, key, duration, and starting bid. Listing goes live immediately with status `OPEN`.

02 **Visitors browse & preview**

Any visitor can stream a low-bitrate preview, see metadata, current bid, bid count, and time remaining. No account needed to listen.

03 **First bid starts the clock**

Bidder enters handle + email + amount (≥ starting bid). Auction status transitions `OPEN → LIVE` and the 30-minute countdown begins.

04 **Competition heats up**

Each new bid must clear the current top bid by at least the minimum increment ($5 default). The Leaderboard re-ranks live; cards flash; previous top bidder gets an outbid notification.

05 **Anti-snipe extension**

If a valid bid is placed in the final 2 minutes, the timer resets to **2:00** remaining. This repeats indefinitely until 2 full minutes pass without a new bid.

06 **Auction closes**

When the timer hits zero with no further activity: payment is captured from the winner's pre-authorized card; the listing is removed from the public site; sale is recorded in the producer's Studio.

07 **Delivery**

Within 60 seconds of close, the winner receives a styled email containing a 7-day signed download URL with the WAV file, stems (if attached), and a PDF exclusive license.

07 FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

What the system must do

F1. Catalog & Listing (Producer)

F1.1	Owner can upload audio (.wav / .mp3 / .aiff, ≤ 50 MB) with metadata: title, BPM, key, genre, duration, starting bid.	MUST	Studio
F1.2	Owner-only access to the upload screen; gated by owner authentication (email + password or magic link).	MUST	Auth
F1.3	System auto-detects audio duration on upload; producer can override.	SHOULD	Studio
F1.4	Owner can attach stems and a custom license PDF per beat (defaults to template if missing).	SHOULD	Studio
F1.5	Owner can edit/cancel a listing only while it has zero bids.	MUST	Studio

F2. Public Marketplace

F2.1	Visitors see a grid of all live auctions with cover, title, current bid, bid count, time remaining, status badge.	MUST	Web
F2.2	Audio preview plays from the beat card without page navigation; only one beat plays at a time.	MUST	Web
F2.3	Filter by genre; search by title.	SHOULD	Web
F2.4	Sold beats are removed from the marketplace within 1 second of auction close.	MUST	Web

F3. Bidding

F3.1	Bidder must provide handle + email + (later) payment authorization before first bid.	MUST	Bid
F3.2	Bid must be ≥ starting bid (first bid) or ≥ current bid + min increment ($5) for subsequent bids.	MUST	Bid
F3.3	First bid sets `endsAt = now + 30 min`. Subsequent bids in the last 2 min reset to `now + 2 min`.	MUST	Bid

F3.4	When outbid, previous top bidder receives an instant email and (if on-site) a toast notification.	MUST	Notify
F3.5	Bid history is fully public on each beat detail / modal: bidder handle, amount, timestamp.	MUST	Bid

F4. Live Leaderboard

F4.1	Sticky panel ranks the top 6 live auctions by heat score (bid count × 10 + current bid × 0.1 + urgency boost when < 5 min left).	MUST	Web
F4.2	Each row shows current bid, time left, and a flame indicator at ≥ 4 bids.	MUST	Web
F4.3	Live activity feed shows the last 6 bid/win events across all auctions, updating in real time.	MUST	Web
F4.4	Tapping a leaderboard row opens its bid modal directly.	SHOULD	Web

F5. Producer Studio

F5.1	Private dashboard with KPIs: live count, sold count, total revenue, average sale.	MUST	Studio
F5.2	Live catalog table with current bid, bid count, top bidder, time left per auction.	MUST	Studio
F5.3	Sales log with delivery ID, winner handle/email, price, date, and re-sendable receipt.	MUST	Studio
F5.4	Optional CSV export of sales for tax / accounting.	COULD	Studio

08 AUCTION RULES

The fine print, made explicit

RULE	VALUE	NOTES
Initial duration	`30:00`	Starts on the first valid bid, not on listing.
Anti-snipe window	`2:00`	If a bid lands inside this window, timer resets to 2:00.
Minimum increment	`$5`	Configurable per beat by producer (range: $1 – $50).
Buyer's premium	`0%`	v1 keeps pricing transparent. Reconsider in v2.
Reserve price	`= starting bid`	v1 has no separate hidden reserve.
Bid retraction	`Not allowed`	All bids are final & binding once placed.
Idle resolution	`No bids`	Listing remains `OPEN` indefinitely. Producer may pull it.
Failed payment	`3 retries → 2nd-place`	If winner's card declines after 3 attempts, offer to runner-up at their last bid.

EDGE CASE

Two valid bids submitted within ~50 ms of each other are reconciled by server timestamp; whichever lands first wins the top slot. The other receives an "outbid" event and refund of their authorization hold.

09 DELIVERY & EMAIL

Closing the loop

Within 60 seconds of auction close, the winner is sent a transactional email containing:

- Beat title, BPM, key, genre, final price.
- Signed download URL (S3 presigned, expires in **7 days**) for: WAV master + stems (if available) + signed exclusive license PDF.
- Delivery ID (format `BAF-{base36 timestamp}`) for support & chargeback evidence.
- License terms abstract: exclusive use, full ownership transfer of the underlying instrumental, perpetual, worldwide.

The same delivery is recorded in the Producer's Studio > Sales log, with a "Re-send" action in case of bounces. Email service: Resend or Postmark; we will run SPF + DKIM + DMARC on a dedicated subdomain (`deliveries.buyafrobeats.com`).

10 NON-FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

Quality bars

AREA	REQUIREMENT
Realtime	Bid → leaderboard update visible to all viewers in < 1 s p95 (WebSockets / SSE).
Reliability	Auction state durable; no bid is silently lost. Server-authoritative timer (do not trust the client).
Performance	First Contentful Paint < 1.5 s on 4G; preview audio TTFB < 400 ms.
Security	OAuth or magic-link auth for producer; SCA-compliant card auth for bidders; signed S3 URLs only.
Anti-fraud	Pre-authorize bidder card on first bid; rate-limit per IP; CAPTCHA after 3 rapid bids.
Accessibility	WCAG 2.1 AA. All controls keyboard-reachable; live regions for bid updates.
Mobile	Fully responsive; touch targets ≥ 44 px; bid modal usable one-handed.

11 SUCCESS METRICS

How we'll know it's working

SELL-THROUGH

≥ 70%

% of listed beats receiving ≥ 1 bid within 14 days.

BIDS PER AUCTION

≥ 4

Median bid count on auctions that close with a winner.

PREMIUM UPLIFT

2.5×

Final price ÷ starting bid, averaged across closed auctions.

LURKER CONVERSION

≥ 8%

Visitors who place ≥ 1 bid within their first session.

SNIPE-EXTEND RATE

≥ 30%

Auctions extended at least once by anti-snipe — proxy for real competition.

DELIVERY SLO

< 60 s

Time from auction close → winner's email delivered (p95).

12 RISKS & OPEN QUESTIONS

What could go wrong

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	MITIGATION
Cold-start: nobody bids → no urgency → nobody bids.	High	Owner-curated launch drops; email list pre-warmed; guest ”watching” counters; optional shill-disclosure stalking-horse bids.
Card declines after winning auction.	Medium	Pre-authorize card on first bid; auto-cascade to runner-up with their original bid honored.
Buyer redistributes the file (”exclusivity” violated).	Medium	Watermarked previews; signed license PDF with explicit clawback clause; takedown SOP.
Timer drift / race conditions on close.	Medium	Server-authoritative clock; bid acceptance window enforced server-side; transactional close.
Email deliverability fails on winner’s domain.	Low	Dedicated sending subdomain + SPF/DKIM/DMARC; in-product download fallback in Studio > My Wins.

Open questions

1. Should there be a bidder-account login (so winners can see all their wins in one place)?
2. Do we want a "Watch this auction" button that emails users 5 min before close?
3. Should producer be able to set a hidden reserve different from starting bid?
4. Does the producer take a fee from delivery (no — we own the platform), or is there a future creator program?
5. Tax/VAT handling for international buyers — Stripe Tax, or out-of-scope for v1?

13 MILESTONES

Path to launch

PHASE	SCOPE	TARGET
M0 · Prototype	Clickable HTML prototype with simulated bidding (this artifact).	Apr 2026 ✓
M1 · Closed Alpha	Real auth, real bidding (sandbox payments), real email delivery. Producer + 10 invited bidders.	Jun 2026
M2 · Public Beta	Stripe live mode, watermarked previews, anti-snipe + outbid emails, leaderboard SSE.	Aug 2026
M3 · v1 Launch	License PDF generation, mobile polish, "Watch this auction" alerts, SEO & share cards.	Q3 2026
M4 · v1.1	Bidder accounts & "My Wins" library, CSV export, hidden reserve.	Q4 2026

DECISION NEEDED

Confirm M1 cohort (which artists/A&Rs to invite to seed competitive bidding) and lock the first 10 launch beats by end of May.

APPROVED BY · PRODUCER / OWNER

Date

REVIEWED BY · ENGINEERING LEAD

Date